

## *Prayers for Purity*

*PRAYERS TO BE READ WHEN IT HAPPENETH THAT ONE IS TEMPTED IN SLEEP*

*or*

*WHEN AWAKE BY THE MALICE OF THE DEVIL*

*Large Font:* <http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/prayers-for-purity-large-font.doc>

*Booklet:* <http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/prayers-for-purity-large-font-booklet.pdf>

*The Booklet should be printed DUPLEX, Landscape orientation, flipping pages on the short side.*

*Normal Font:* <http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/prayers-for-purity.doc>

### Contents

|                                                                                          |    |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| How to use this Book. ....                                                               | 3  |
| Ask the Holy Spirit for cleansing , at ANY time. ....                                    | 5  |
| Arising from bed, make three prostrations, saying, ....                                  | 9  |
| PSALM 50.....                                                                            | 10 |
| PSALM 142.....                                                                           | 11 |
| PSALM 69.....                                                                            | 12 |
| DOXOLOGY .....                                                                           | 12 |
| The Symbol of the Orthodox Faith.....                                                    | 13 |
| The Dismissal .....                                                                      | 14 |
| Then we say kontakion for the day, if known; then the following penitential hymns: ..... | 14 |
| Then the following penitential hymns are read: .....                                     | 16 |
| A Prayer by the Monk Mark .....                                                          | 18 |
| A Prayer by Saint Basil.....                                                             | 19 |
| Another Prayer by Saint Basil or of Saint Martinianos.....                               | 19 |
| After these prayers we do fifty prostrations, saying at each one:.....                   | 21 |
| Then we read these prayers: .....                                                        | 21 |

|                                                                               |    |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| The Prayer of Saint Mardarios .....                                           | 21 |
| Instructions.....                                                             | 23 |
| Other Prayers from the Great Euchologion in Warfare Against Fornication ..... | 24 |
| A Prayer Against Evil Thoughts .....                                          | 25 |
| A Prayer Said Before Sleep and After Defilement in Sleep.....                 | 26 |
| Hymns to Various Saints Who Struggled Against Carnal Temptations .....        | 27 |
| Saint Mary of Egypt.....                                                      | 27 |
| Saint Moses The Hungarian .....                                               | 27 |
| Saint Photini the Samaritan .....                                             | 28 |
| Saint Thais the Former Harlot.....                                            | 28 |
| Saint Pelagia the Former Courtesan .....                                      | 28 |
| Saint Zlata the New Martyr .....                                              | 29 |
| Saint Boniface and Aglais .....                                               | 29 |
| Saint Eudocia .....                                                           | 29 |
| Saint Thomais .....                                                           | 30 |
| Saint Pelagia, Virgin Martyr of Rome .....                                    | 30 |
| Saint Marcella .....                                                          | 30 |
| Saint Basil of Mangazeya.....                                                 | 31 |
| Saint Niphon, Bishop of Constantinople .....                                  | 31 |
| The Patriarch Joseph the All-Comely, Tone 8.....                              | 31 |
| More prayers for Purity.....                                                  | 32 |
| Exhortations from Holy Scriptures to Purity .....                             | 34 |
| GLORY BE TO GOD FOR ALL THINGS. AMEN.....                                     | 35 |

## How to use this Book.

See the instructions at the end of the service, if you have an impure dream and/or a nocturnal emission during sleep. Of course, you should verify those instructions with your spiritual father or confessor.

If your spiritual father or confessor does not think that this book is important, you should find another confessor! Unfortunately, in our day there are confessors who do not emphasize purity and chastity.

You should say this rule in its entirety whenever you are tempted to impurity (whether you act completely on the temptation or not), whether it be by pornography, self-abuse, or even fantasy or watching a questionable movie etc. You must know the movements of your heart. If you do something that's impure and is dangerous to you because that impurity can escalate, then you should say this rule. Other

impurities that you can say this rule for would be drug use and drunkenness.

If you are sometimes tempted to any kind of sexual impurity or intoxication, etc., then you always carry that sin with you whether you are engaging in that activity or not. Therefore, if you are serious about ending your impurity, you should say this rule or a portion of it daily. The rule is very long to say every day, but you could take a few of the troparia that you really like or a few of the prayers that you really like and say them every day in your rule. This is VERY beneficial. Most of the prayers are assuming that there is been a fall. If you are saying these prayers to prevent a fall, you can change the tense of the verbs, or edit the text a little bit to make the prayer proactive (to prevent sin) rather than reactive (said after sin).

If you are tempted to any kind of impurity, it is good to call it what it is and make 12 prostrations every day begging the Lord to help you. For instance, you could say: “Lord Jesus Christ, have mercy on me and help me to not look at pornography today.”

Or “Lord Jesus Christ, have mercy on me and help me to guard my eyes from impure glances today.”

Or you can be more graphic and exact and call a spade a spade: “...help me to not look at pornography or masturbate today.” If it is hard to say those words aloud, think how much horrible it is to do them!

You could also just pray for chastity: “Lord Jesus Christ, help me to be chaste today.” Unfortunately the English word “chastity” is not as evocative as the Russian word “целомудрие”. This word literally

means “complete wisdom”. My bishop, Archbishop Peter, described it to me as “chastity, full to the brim”. This is a wonderful image! Chastity is actually a completeness in the soul and self-control in all things, not just sexual sins. A person who is struggling with disordered sexual sins will have other disorders in their life, and we are looking not just to be free of sexual sins but be free of all disorders. We are looking for chastity.

Be creative, and ask for help with the things that you regularly have trouble with. This kind of flagrant honesty and always bringing your sins before your face and before the Lord will help you immensely. If you sometimes have a problem with pornography or self-abuse or anything else, and you are aware of this problem every day and pray the Lord will protect you then will be very strong when temptations come.

Ask the Holy Spirit for cleansing , at ANY time.

We pray to the Holy Spirit every day, especially with the prayer “O Heavenly King.” Everyone should know this prayer by heart, and we should pray at least twice a day, in our morning and evening rule.

O Heavenly King, Comforter,  
Spirit of Truth, Who art  
everywhere present and fillest all  
things, O Treasury of good things  
and Giver of Life: Come and dwell  
in us, and ***cleanse us of all  
impurity*** and save our souls O  
Good One.

The Holy Spirit is known for His  
cleansing and enlightening of our souls.  
He is symbolized by water, which, of  
course, is cleansing and life-giving, and  
fire, which cleanses and purges, and the  
dove, which is a very clean bird. He is also  
referred to as the wind, and the wind goes  
where it wishes and cannot be stopped.  
The Holy Spirit can easily cleanse us even  
when we feel absolutely defiled.

Here are two suggestions regarding  
temptations of defilement, ***exactly when  
they are happening***. The temptation can  
be defilement by lust, or judgment of  
others, or cursing, or anger, or, really, any  
sin. All sin defiles us, and the Holy Spirit  
can cleanse us of all sin and defilement.

One thing you may do, once, or many  
times, is to pray “O Heavenly King” with  
great fervor and effort.

Another thing to do is to pray in an  
abbreviated way to ask the Holy Spirit for  
cleansing from defilement. Sometimes  
when we are tempted, it is very difficult to  
say a long prayer. The temptation comes  
upon us very quickly, even surprising us,  
and with great force! And we must pray  
quickly and with attention! The best  
prayer in that case is a short prayer.

Below is an article from Metropolitan  
Neophytos of Morphou, Cyprus. This is an  
excerpt from one of his sermons, and it is  
something that I try to teach anyone who  
will listen. As you read the article, note  
how he was enjoying a beautiful day and  
suddenly was assaulted with an unclean

image. And he fought back in a simple, forthright and even “violent” way.

The cleansing of the Holy Spirit is really that close to us. Don’t forget this, even when you are overcome by unclean thoughts, and even when you are about to give into these thoughts and perform an unclean action. You can always say this prayer and you can always be rescued from defilement.

From Without Being Crucified, We Will Not Be Resurrected, We Will Not Be Glorified,  
Met Neophytos of Morphou, Pp 128-241:

... Yesterday we celebrated a Liturgy, so magnificent, glorious. We rejoiced, and our Elder rejoiced...

In the afternoon we ate tasty eggplants, and once I rested at six thirty with our deacon and our future deacon George, we headed towards the area of St Nicholas of Orounta.

We passed along a certain road where someone had once told me: "You know, in such and such a farm of shepherds (there are farms in that area), I saw two people who were committing a sin."

He told me that when I was a hieromonk, and I took it as hearsay. How many things don't we hear! But, for temptation to try me, whether I am watchful, whether I have "watchful mind, chaste thought, a sober heart" [from the Compline service], when we were passing and I saw the farm, I heard inside of me: "do you remember what that shepherd told you, what vulgarity he saw in there?" And my mind started imagining and conjecturing. Then I called on the ***Holy Spirit: Holy Spirit, Spirit of Truth, cleanse me!*** And again, and again, I said it 6 or 7 times, and immediately my imagination was cleansed. Do you understand? But it existed stored inside of me as a memory, as hearsay, when I never saw anything, someone just told me.

But do you see how our defiled self keeps these things, and when it presented them to me? At a time when I was joyful, I had served Liturgy, I had communed, I ate the eggplants, I slept, I awoke, I

entered the car as a bishop, and immediately imagination or fantasy which is one of the five senses of the soul, was activated.

Let's see what my guardian angel said to me: "Shall we now see, Neophytos, what kind of feast you celebrated? Was it only for the beautiful hymns that your deacons and chanters sang, or do you know how to cleanse your heart of memories, imaginations, desires, and thoughts?" Glory to God, alone we can't do it: "without Me ye can do nothing". (John 15:5) The Holy Spirit, however, Whom I have loved perhaps since child-hood, can. And our holy Elders helped us to love It more and then to learn how It is activated, how it "startari" [slang from the English word "start", to activate], and the engine of the Holy Spirit begins to work as soon as you call upon It.

That's why I ask you, beloved, to engage in this activity. I just confessed. Whenever you see whatever disturbs your heart: it can be anger, it can be jealousy, you

can see some-one who once said a bitter word to you, immediately prevent the thought from taking root, because it will get stronger and you will have a harder time with it. But pray immediately with watchful mind: ***Holy Spirit, Spirit of Truth, cleanse me!*** And I suggest that you find some time every day to say a few times: "O Heavenly King..." slowly, nicely, as St Evmenios used to say: "nicely, nicely, nicely!" And may every word enter into you.

That way, when you call upon Him, He will be "stored in the memory of your hard drive", and immediately It will be activated and will cleanse. David, who wrote the Psalter, and whom we love very much, says, brothers and sisters: "from my secret sins cleanse me." (Psalm 18:11)

You see? David lived 1000 years before Christ, he was of the Old Testament, and he was concerned about how to cleanse himself from hidden passions. The obvious things we find eas-ily, we see them in

front of us; but we have hidden things, old things, that we haven't confessed, that we haven't repented of. And when they come to our memory, it's the opportunity of our life to repent, to erase them.

If I hadn't done that yesterday, holy Reader, do you know what would have happened? I would have found that vulgar imagination in front of me after death, the demons would have yelled it at me. Do you hear? "Do you remember, pseudo-Neophytos, when you were returning from Mavrovouni and we brought you that old imagination and you didn't struggle against it, you didn't repel it, but you entertained it?" Nothing gets erased... only the Holy Spirit can. That's why Christ says in the Gospel: "Without Me ye can do nothing." (John 15:5)

Now, if you don't do this work of cleansing, as the saints say, first a turmoil will come into our hearts, then distress, and then fear, much

fear. You see what's happening these last years with fear, how much they've taken advantage of it? And after fear - - if we don't manage to drive it away - will come panic, terror; and a chaotic state inside of us. We won't know which way is up, we'll blame everyone, but the problem will be us.

That's why I plead with you to constantly talk to the Holy Spirit, to say the "O Heavenly King..." a few times each day, slowly and nicely, and say it humbly, just loud enough for the ear to hear it... that's how the senses of the body are also sanctified. And when anything from the past comes, or from the present that disturbs you, that creates a problem either of thoughts, or desires, or anger, immediately call upon the Holy Spirit and It will cleanse, It will sanctify. That way, when our soul goes before our Lord, it will have a good defense before His dread judgment seat.

Arising from bed, make three prostrations, saying,

O God be merciful to me a sinner.

In the Name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit.

Glory to thee, O God, Glory to Thee.

Heavenly King, Comforter, Spirit of Truth, Who art everywhere present and fillest all things, O Treasury of good things and Giver of Life: Come and dwell in us, and cleanse us of all impurity and save our souls O Good One.

Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal, have mercy on us. (3x)

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, both now and ever and unto ages of ages. Amen.

All Holy Trinity, have mercy on us. Lord be gracious unto our sins. Master,

pardon our iniquities, O Holy One visit and heal our infirmities for Thy name's sake.

Lord have mercy. (3x)

Glory to the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit, both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

Our Father, Who art in the heavens, hallowed by Thy name. Thy kingdom come, Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread and forgive us our debts as we forgive our debtors; and lead us not into temptation. but deliver us from the evil one.

**Through the prayers of our holy Fathers, Lord Jesus Christ our God, have mercy on us. Amen.**

Lord have mercy. (3x)

Glory to the Father, and to the Son,  
and to the Holy Spirit, both now and  
ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

O come let us worship God our King.

O come let us worship and fall down  
before Christ our King and God.

O come let us worship and fall down  
before Christ Himself, our King and  
God.

### PSALM 50

Have mercy on me, O God, according  
to Thy great mercy; and according to  
the multitude of Thy compassions blot  
out my transgression. Wash me  
thoroughly from mine iniquity and  
cleanse me from my sin. For I know my  
iniquity and my sin is ever before me.  
Against Thee only have I sinned and  
done this evil against Thee, that Thou  
mightest be justified in Thy words, and  
prevail when Thou art judged. For  
behold, I was conceived in iniquities  
and in sins did my mother bear me. For  
behold, Thou hast loved truth; the  
hidden and secret things of Thy  
wisdom hast Thou made manifest unto  
me. Thou shalt sprinkle me with hyssop  
and I shall be made clean. Thou shalt  
wash me, and I shall be made whiter

than snow. Thou shalt make me to  
hear joy and gladness; the bones that  
be humbled they shall rejoice. Turn Thy  
face away from my sins, and blot out  
mine iniquities. Create in me a clean  
heart, O God, and renew a right spirit  
within me. Cast me not away from Thy  
presence and take not Thy Holy Spirit  
from me. Restore unto me the joy of  
Thy salvation, and with Thy governing  
Spirit establish me, I shall teach  
transgressors Thy ways and the  
ungodly shall turn back unto Thee.  
Deliver me from blood-guiltiness, O  
God, Thou God of my salvation; my  
tongue shall rejoice in Thy  
righteousness. O Lord, Thou shalt open  
my lips and my mouth shall declare Thy  
praise. For if Thou hadst desired

sacrifice, I had given it; with whole-burnt offerings Thou shalt not be pleased. A sacrifice unto God is a broken spirit; a heart that is broken and humbled God will not despise. Do good, O Lord, in Thy good pleasure

unto Sion and let the walls of Jerusalem be builded. Then Thou shalt be pleased with a sacrifice of righteousness, with oblation and whole-burnt offerings. Then shall they offer bullocks upon Thine altar.

### *PSALM 142*

O Lord, hear my prayer; give ear unto my supplication in thy truth; hearken unto me in Thy righteousness. And enter not into judgment with Thy servant, for in Thy sight shall no man living be justified. For the enemy hath persecuted my soul; he hath humbled my life down to the earth. He hath sat me in darkness as have been long dead, and my spirit within me is become despondent; within me my heart is troubled. I remembered the days of old, I meditated on all Thy works, I pondered on the creations of Thy hands. I stretched forth my hands unto Thee; my soul thirsteth after Thee like a waterless land. Quickly hear me, O Lord; my spirit hath fainted away. Turn

not Thy face away from me, lest I be like unto them that go down into the pit. Cause me to hear Thy mercy in the morning; for in Thee have I put my hope. Cause me to know, O Lord, the way wherein I should walk; for unto Thee have I lifted up my soul. Rescue me from mine enemies, O Lord, unto Thee have I fled for refuge. Teach me to do Thy will, for Thou art my God. Thy good Spirit shall lead me in the land of uprightness; for Thy Name's sake, O Lord, shalt Thou quicken me. In Thy righteousness shall Thou bring my soul out of affliction, and in Thy mercy shalt Thou utterly destroy my enemies. And Thou shalt cut off all them that afflict my soul, for I am Thy servant.

*PSALM 69*

O God, be attentive unto helping me;  
O Lord, make haste to help me. Let  
them be shamed and confounded that  
seek after my soul. Let them be turned  
back and brought to shame that desire  
evils against me. Let them be turned  
back straightway in shame that say  
unto me: Well done! Well done! Let

them be glad and rejoice in Thee all  
that seek after Thee, O God, and let  
them that love Thy salvation say  
continually: The Lord be magnified. But  
as for me, I am poor and needy; O God,  
come unto mine aid. My helper and my  
deliverer art Thou, O Lord; make no  
long tarrying.

*DOXOLOGY*

Glory to God in the highest, and on  
earth peace, good will among men. We  
praise thee, we bless Thee, we worship  
Thee, we glorify Thee, we thank Thee  
for Thy great glory. O Lord, heavenly  
King, God the Father Almighty; O Lord,  
the only-begotten Son, Jesus Christ and  
the Holy Spirit. O Lord God, Lamb of  
God, Son of the Father, that takest  
away the sins of the world. Receive our  
prayer, Thou that sittest at the right  
hand of the Father, and have mercy on  
us. For Thou alone art holy, Thou only  
art Lord, Jesus Christ, to the glory of  
God the Father. Amen

Every day will I bless Thee, and I will  
praise Thy name forever, yea, forever  
and ever.

O Lord, Thou hast been our refuge  
from generation and generation. I have  
said: O Lord have mercy in me; heal my  
soul for I have sinned against Thee. O  
Lord, unto Thee have I fled for refuge;  
teach me to do Thy will for Thou art my  
God. For in Thee is the fountain of Life;  
in Thy light we shall see light. O  
continue Thy mercy unto them that  
know thee. Vouchsafe, O Lord, to keep  
us this night without sin. Blessed art  
Thou, O Lord, God of our Fathers, and  
praised and glorified is Thy name unto  
the ages of ages. Amen.

Let Thy mercy be upon us, O Lord, as we have set our hope on Thee.

Blessed art Thou, O Lord, teach me Thy statutes.

Blessed art Thou, O Lord, grant me understanding of Thy statutes.

Blessed art Thou, O Lord, enlighten me by Thy statutes O Lord. Thy mercy

endureth forever; despise not the works of Thy hands.

Unto Thee belongeth praise; to Thee belongeth worship; to Thee glory belongeth: to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever and unto ages of ages.

### *The Symbol of the Orthodox Faith*

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, Maker of heaven and earth, and of all things visible and invisible. And in one Lord Jesus Christ, the only-begotten Son of God; begotten of the Father before all ages; Light from Light, True God from True God, begotten, not made, of One Essence with the Father, through Whom all things were made: Who for us men, and for our salvation, came down from Heaven, and was incarnate by the Holy Spirit and the Virgin Mary, and became Man: And was crucified for us under Pontius Pilate, and suffered and was buried: And He rose on the third day according to the

Scriptures: And ascended into Heaven, and sits at the right hand of the Father: And He is coming again with glory to judge the living and the dead; And His Kingdom will have no end: And in the Holy Spirit, the Lord, the Giver of the Life, Who proceeds from the Father, Who with the Father and the Son is equally worshipped and glorified, Who spoke by the Prophets: And in One, Holy, Catholic and Apostolic Church. I confess one Baptism for the remission of sins. I look for the Resurrection of the Dead; And the life of the Age to come. Amen.

O God, absolve, remit and pardon our voluntary and involuntary sins, in word and deed, known and unknown, by day and by night, in mind and thought; forgive us in all Thy goodness and love of mankind.

*The Dismissal*

**Through the prayers of our holy Fathers, O Lord Jesus Christ our God, have mercy on us. Amen.**

*Then we say kontakion for the day, if known; then the following penitential hymns:*

I have sinned against Thee, O Savior, as did the Prodigal Son; accept me in repentance, O Father, and have mercy on me, O God.

I cry unto Thee, O Christ Savior, with the voice of the Publican: be Thou gracious unto me, as Thou wast unto him, and have mercy on me O God.

*To the Theotokos*

Do thou show thy protection and speedy help to us, and thy mercy upon all thy faithful servants, Maid; and becalm, O most pure One, every stormy wave of all vain and futile thoughts; and do thou resurrect my fallen soul, O blessed Theotokos; for I know, yea, I know, O blest Virgin, that thou canst do whatever thou dost will.

Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal, have mercy on us. *(3x)*

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, both now and ever and unto ages of ages. Amen.

All Holy Trinity, have mercy on us. Lord be gracious unto our sins. Master,

pardon our iniquities, O Holy One visit and heal our infirmities for Thy names sake.

Lord have mercy. *(3x)*

Glory to the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit, both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

Our Father, Who art in the heavens,  
hallowed by Thy name. Thy kingdom  
come, Thy will be done, on earth as it is  
in heaven. Give us this day our daily  
bread and forgive us our debts as we  
forgive our debtors; and lead us not

into temptation. but deliver us from the  
evil one.

**Through the prayers of our holy  
Fathers, Lord Jesus Christ our  
God, have mercy on us. Amen.**

*Then the following penitential hymns are read:*

As he who fell among the thieves and was sorely wounded, I too have fallen because of mine own sins, and my soul is gravely wounded. Unto Whom shall I flee for refuge, I who have brought this upon myself, except unto Thee, the compassionate healer of souls. Pour out upon me, O God, Thy great mercy.

I have come unto Thee, O Compassionate One, as did the Prodigal Son. Receive me, as I fall down before Thee, as one of Thy hired servants, O God, and have mercy on me.

Having fallen among the thieves of mine own thoughts, my mind hath been stripped from me, the miserable one; and all my soul is terribly wounded, and I lie there in the path of life naked of any virtue. The priest, seeing me in the agony of my unhealable wounds, looks past me and doth not attend unto me. And again, the Levite, unable to bear my soul-destroying pain, he too, seeing doth not attend unto me. But Thou, Who in Thy good will wast incarnate,

not from Samaria, but from Maria, O Christ God, in Thy man-befriending manner grant me healing, pouring upon me Thy great mercy.

I bring to mind that fearful day, and I mourn for my evil actions. How shall I render an account to the Immortal King? With what boldness shall I, the prodigal, look unto the Judge? O merciful Father, Only-begotten son, and Holy Spirit have mercy on me.

In the valley of tears, in that place which Thou hast ordained, when thou sittest, O Merciful One, to make that just judgment, do not make public all my hidden deeds, nor shame me before the Angels; but spare me, O God, and have mercy on me.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.

It is I who am that unfruitful tree, O Lord, bearing no fruit of compunction at all; I fear being cut down at my very roots, and I cringe at that fire that is never quenched. Wherefore I beseech

Thee: Before that violent moment give me repentance and save me.

Both now and ever and unto ages of ages. Amen.

Thou are the good hope of the world,  
O Virgin Theotokos; thy fearsome

protection only do I seek. Have compassion upon me, the sinner, and entreat the merciful God to save my soul from every threat, thou only blessed One.

Lord have mercy. (40x)

*A Prayer by the Monk Mark*

O undefiled, pure, all-merciful Lord,  
Who in taking on Thy humanity didst  
free our nature from corruption; and by  
uniting it with that which is superior  
didst totally sanctify it; Thou Who unto  
those who confidently believe in Thee,  
the only True One, dost grant richly of  
Thy grace; Thou Who hast shamed that  
ancient and arrogant one who tripped  
us up in the weakness of the flesh; do  
Thou, the same beneficent Lord,  
cleanse me the passionate and sin-  
loving one, who hast been defiled by  
mine imaginations during sleep, of  
every impurity of body and soul.  
Account this not unto me as a sin,  
whether I was defiled by a dream borne  
of the malice of that unnamed and  
good-hating demon, or whether by  
immoderation in hurtful things, or  
whether by evil habit and overbearing

presumption. From this time forward,  
strengthen me against his sinister rage  
by Thine all-powerful grace and  
preserve me above his various evil  
plans, maintaining the lamp of my  
chastity undimmed unto the end. So  
that, being rescued from the ticklings of  
abominable passions and from the  
fearsome gloom of nighttime fantasies  
by Thy power, I may meditate day and  
night upon the luminous vision of Thy  
judgments, which are sweeter and  
more to be desired than honey and  
honey comb; and in purity of  
conscience, I may be deemed worthy to  
participate in Thy life-giving and  
immortal Mysteries. Through the  
intercession of Her who bore Thee  
without corruption, our most pure  
Lady, the Theotokos and Ever virgin  
Mary, and of all the Saints. Amen.

*A Prayer by Saint Basil*

O all-merciful, incorrupt, pure, undefiled, only sinless Lord, cleanse me, Thy useless servant from all defilements of body and soul, and from the impurity which hath happened to me because of my carelessness and indifference, together with all mine other iniquities. Purify me of every stain by the grace of Thy Christ; sanctify me by sending down Thy Holy Spirit; so that, rising up from the fog of mine impurities and the fantasies of the devil, and from every diabolical defilement, I might be made

worthy in pure conscience to open my foul and polluted mouth to praise Thine all-holy Name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit; and thereby to participate guiltlessly and uncondemned in the most pure, immortal, most holy and life-giving Mysteries of Thine only-begotten Son, our Lord and God and Savior Jesus Christ; with Whom Thou art blessed, together with Thine all-holy, good and life-creating Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

*Another Prayer by Saint Basil or of Saint Martinianos*

Again, have I the wretched one been tripped up in my mind by serving my evil and sinful habits. Again, I am dragged as a captive by the prince of darkness and the father of passionate pleasure; and as a slave, humiliated by his will, he forces me to serve the desires of the flesh. And what am I to do, O Lord, O Lord, redeemer and defender of all who hope in Thee; but to turn again to Thee, and sigh, and beg

for forgiveness for the things which I have done. But I fear and tremble that perhaps even though I confess daily and try to avoid evil things, yet still I cease not to sin every hour, and fail to render my prayer to Thee, my God, I might yet incite Thy patience unto wrath. And who can bear Thine anger O Lord? Wherefore, knowing that multitude of Thy compassions and the abyss of Thy love for mankind, again I throw myself

upon Thy mercy, and I cry unto Thee, saying: I have sinned, O Lord; have mercy on me, the fallen one. Grant unto me Thy hand in help, who am sunk in the pit of pleasures; and do not abandon me O Lord, Thy servant, to be destroyed by mine iniquities and my sins. Rather, in Thy usual goodness deliver me from the pollution and the stain of my flesh and from my passionate thoughts which in every day defile my miserable soul. Behold, O Lord my God, there is not even one place in it which is clean, but it is altogether leprous; my body itself is one great wound. Let Thou Thyself, therefore, as the healer of souls and the wellspring of life, cleanse my soul with tears which Thou shalt pour out upon

me abundantly. Grant me healing and cleansing and turn not Thy face from me, lest the darkness of despair consume me as fire. But as Thou Thyself, the all-true God, hast said that there is joy in heaven at the return of a sinner, let this be unto me, a sinner. Close not the ears of Thy compassion against the prayer of my repentance; but open them unto me and direct my prayer before Thee as incense. Thou the Creator, knowest the weakness of our nature, how easily we slip in our youth; yet Thou overlookest the sins and Thou acceptest the repentance of those who confess to Thee in truth. For Thou alone art sinless, and unto thee do we send up glory, now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

*After these prayers we do fifty prostrations, saying at each one:*

**"O God be gracious to me, a sinner, and have mercy on me, for Thy holy Name's sake."**

*or we say*

**"I have sinned against Thee, O Lord, forgive me the prodigal."**

*Then we read these prayers:*

Thou Who at all times and at every hour, in heaven and on earth, art worshipped and glorified, O Christ God, Who art long-suffering, plenteous in mercy, most compassionate, Who lovest the righteous and hast mercy on sinners; Who callest all men to salvation through the promise of good things to come: Receive, O Lord, our prayers at this hour, and guide our life toward Thy commandments. Sanctify our souls, make chaste our bodies, correct our thoughts, purify our intentions, and deliver us from every sorrow, evil, and pain. Compass us about with Thy holy angels, that, guarded and guided by their array, we may attain to the unity of the faith and

to the knowledge of Thine unapproachable glory: For blessed art Thou unto ages of ages. Amen.

More honorable than the cherubim and beyond compare more glorious than the seraphim; who without corruption gavest birth to God the Word, the very Theotokos, thee do we magnify.

*The Prayer of Saint Mardarios*

Sovereign God, the Father Almighty, the Lord, the Only-begotten Son, Jesus Christ, and Thou, Holy Spirit, one Godhead, one Power, have mercy on me, a sinner, and by the judgments which Thou knowest save me; Thine unworthy servant; for blessed art Thou unto ages of ages. Amen.

*Then*

Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy  
Immortal, have mercy on us. (3x)

Glory to the Father, and to the Son,  
and to the Holy Spirit, both now and  
ever and unto ages of ages. Amen.

O Most Holy Trinity, have mercy on  
us. O Lord blot out our sins. O Master  
pardon our iniquities. O Holy One visit  
and heal our infirmities for Thy name's  
sake.

Lord have mercy. (3x)

Glory to the Father, and to the Son,  
and to the Holy Spirit, both now and  
ever and unto ages of ages. Amen.

Our Father, Who art in the heavens,  
hallowed by Thy name. Thy kingdom  
come, Thy will be done, on earth as it is  
in heaven. Give us this day our daily  
bread and forgive us our debts as we  
forgive our debtors; and lead us not  
into temptation. but deliver us from the  
evil one.

**Through the prayers of our holy  
Fathers, Lord Jesus Christ our  
God, have mercy on us. Amen.**

Lord have mercy. (12x)

More honorable than the cherubim and beyond compare more glorious than the seraphim; who without corruption gavest birth to God the Word, the very Theotokos, thee do we magnify.

To thee, the Champion Leader, we thy flock dedicate a feast of victory and thanksgiving, as ones rescued out of suffering, O Theotokos. But as thou art one with might which is invincible, from all dangers that can be do thou deliver us; that we may cry unto thee: rejoice thou Bride unwedded.

**Through the prayers of our holy Fathers, Lord Jesus Christ our God, have mercy on us. Amen.**

#### *Instructions*

*And if the fantasy was of demonic influence, a priest may read this service and a layman may communicate. If, however, it occurred because of drunkenness, let them abstain from serving or communing, according to the Fathers, and seek counsel from the Spiritual Father.*

## Other Prayers from the Great Euchologion in Warfare Against Fornication

O God of Hosts, Who healest every illness and every infirmity among the people, be gracious unto Thy servants, and do not allow the communion of mankind with the demon. Cast out the unclean spirits' crush Satan under the feet of Thy servants; renew them by Thy Holy Spirit; unite them unto Thy Holy Church, and having redeemed them from every activity of the

adversary, present them before Thy holy Altar, and account them worthy of Thy heavenly and life-giving Mysteries. For Thou art our God, the God of the penitent, and unto Thee do we send up Thee do we send up glory, to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

O Lord, the God of righteousness, my strength and my helper and my refuge in the evil day; Thou art He Who saveth in the time of tribulation. Save me, for the flood-waters have entered in, even unto my soul. I am struck fast in the depths of slime, and I have no power before the face of the enemy which oppresseth me; for he hath pursued my soul, and he hath ground my life down into the earth. He hath troubled me by warring against me all the night. Let it be Thy good pleasure, O Lord, to snatch me from the hand of the iniquitous and unjust one, that I might not sin against

Thee; for the fear of death hath fallen upon me, and darkness hath covered me. Unto whom shall I cry out, O Lord, and he shall not hear me? Being unjustly treated, O Lord, shall I cry out to Thee and wilt Thou ignore me? Look down from Heaven, O Lord, and behold from Thy holy house and from Thy glory. Where is the multitude of Thy compassions, according to Thy mercy wherewith Thou hast borne us? O Lord, judge those who are unjust to me; be not as a man who slumbereth and as a man who is unable to save. For Thou art a merciful and man-befriending God,

and unto Thee do we send up glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the

Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

*A Prayer Against Evil Thoughts*

O Master, Lord my God, in Whose hands are my lots, help me according to Thy mercy and do not allow me to be destroyed with mine iniquities, nor permit me by my will to follow the desires of my flesh against my spirit. I was fashioned by Thee; do not forsake the works of Thy hands. Turn not Thy face, have pity, do not despise me, neither forsake me, O Lord, for I am weak; and it is to thee, my protecting God, that I have come for refuge. Heal my soul, for I have sinned against Thee. Save me for the sake of Thy mercy, for upon Thee have I cast myself from my very youth. May those who war against

me be put to shame, and may those who seek to separate me from thee through immodest acts, unseemly thoughts, and unprofitable recollections be turned back. Chase far from me every filthiness which is the superabundance of evil. For Thou alone art holy; Thou alone art mighty; Thou alone art immortal, having unfathomable power against all things; and it is through Thee that every power is given against the Devil and his forces. Unto Thee is due all glory, honor and worship, to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever and unto ages of ages. Amen.

*A Prayer Said Before Sleep and After Defilement in Sleep*

O All-hymned Lord, Who art true and unspotted; O only sinless One, cleanse me, Thy servant, from every stain of body and soul, and make me to be undefiled by the grace of my Christ. Sanctify me by the descent of the Holy Spirit, so that as I awake from the mist of the unclean fantasies of the devil and

all temptations, I may be accounted at a proper season to approach and taste Thy awesome and terrible Mysteries. For Thou art He Who blesseth and sanctifieth all things, and to Thee do we do we send up glory, to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

## Hymns to Various Saints Who Struggled Against Carnal Temptations

### *Saint Mary of Egypt*

In thee the image was preserved in exactness, O Mother; for taking up the Cross, thou didst follow Christ, and with thy deeds thou didst teach us to overlook the flesh for it passeth away, but to attend to the soul, since it is immortal. Wherefore, O our righteous mother Mary, thy spirit rejoiceth with the angels. Thou who once of old was filled

with all manner of fornication art now seen today to be the bride of Christ by thy repentance. Thou didst love and emulate the life of angels. By the Cross thou didst annihilate the hordes of demons; for the cause art thou a bride now in the kingdom of the heavens, O Mary, thou all-modest one.

### *Saint Moses The Hungarian*

Seeking the one God in the highest, thou didst scorn all earthly things; and taking no care for thy body, thou didst courageously give thyself over to torments. Thou didst valiantly endure hunger, thirst, bonds, and confinement in a dungeon; for the sake of thy virginity, thou

didst endure scourgings, the shedding of thy blood and mutilation. And now as thou standest together with the choir of the virgins before the holy Trinity, pray for the deliverance from all temptations of them that chant to thee; Rejoice, O most blessed Father Moses.

*Saint Photini the Samaritan*

Illumined by the Holy Spirit, and refreshed by the streams of Christ the Savior, O all-lauded one, thou didst drink the water of salvation and didst give

abundantly to them that were athirst. O great martyr and peer of the apostles, holy Photini, do thou entreat Christ God that our souls be saved.

*Saint Thais the Former Harlot*

By asceticism thou didst make thy pure soul radiant, and by repentance thou didst broghtness of thy sacred garment, O renowned Thais. Thou didst dwell in solitude in

the desert, and having emulated the life of the angels, thou didst increase thy love for Christ the Savior. Wherefore thou wast glorified in the heavenly Kingdom.

*Saint Pelagia the Former Courtesan*

Like a fragrant rose coming forth from thorns, O Pelagia, thou wast made manifest to the Church by thy virtuous deeds and wast a source of joy for the faithful. Hence, thou didst offer

thy life as a sweet-smelling fragrance to Him Who hath made thee wondrous, O righteous one. Do thou entreat Him that we be saved from every passion, both of the soul and of the body.

*Saint Zlata the New Martyr*

Thou was a golden vessel of virginity and an undefiled bride of Christ, O Zlata, thou right-glorious virgin; for having preserved thy virginity

blamelessly, thou didst contest for Christ in a godly manner. O glorious martyr, entreat thy bridegroom that we may be granted mercy.

*Saint Boniface and Aglais*

Thou didst fervently aspire to the good fame of the martyrs, and didst profess Christ steadfastly to the unbelievers, O wise Boniface. Wherefore, O martyr,

thou didst give thy relics unto the modest Agias as an inexpendable treasure, wherefrom healing and mercy flow forth for the world.

*Saint Eudocia*

Having bound thy soul with righteousness of mind in love for Christ, as a disciple of the Word thou didst forsake temporal and corruptible beauty. Having first mortified the passions by fasting, thenceforth thou didst put the

enemy to shame by enduring hardship. Wherefore, Christ deemed thee worthy of two-fold crowns, O glorious and righteous martyr Eudocia; do thou entreat Christ God to save our souls.

*Saint Thomas*

Thou didst prove to be a pillar of chastity and a model of a pure life, O Thomas of noble fame; for thou didst shed thy blood for purity's sake and didst put the

dragon to shame. Wherefore do thou entreat Christ God, O all-famed one, that we be granted great mercy.

*Saint Pelagia, Virgin Martyr of Rome*

By the knowledge of the sacred Faith, thou didst abandon the darkness of ignorance, O Pelagia, most comely virgin of Christ. And being refreshed by His

immortal dew, thou didst finish thy contest by fire, O glorious martyr, do thou entreat Christ God that we be granted great mercy.

*Saint Marcella*

Thou didst submit thyself the laws and the divine teachings of the Lord. O Marcella, and that didst strive to keep them blamelessly. And fearing lest thou be violated by thy father, thou didst betake thyself unto the mountains where in pursuit

and search for thee, he slew thee, O undefiled bride of Christ. Glory to Him that hath given thee strength. Glory to Him that crowned thee. Glory to Him that worketh healings for all through thee.

*Saint Basil of Mangazeya*

Thou whose relics were raised  
from the murky depths, raise  
our minds as they lie now deep  
in the depths of sin, and as one  
who fought to keep godly purity,

do thou also send to us speedy  
help from heaven's heights, O  
virgin-martyr Basil, for hell's  
abominations threaten us on  
every side.

*Saint Niphon, Bishop of Constantinople*

In thy youth thou didst journey  
to that land far from the Savior,  
but thy repentance brought thee  
back to the bosom of the Father.  
Thou didst discern the snares of  
the serpent, and didst flee them  
on the wings of prayer. Ascetic  
struggles cleansed thee and  
made thee a worthy vessel to

behold wonders beyond words  
and to serve the Holy Mysteries.

Glory to Christ Who cleansed  
Thee.

Glory to Him Who hath glorified  
thee.

Glory to Him Who purifies all  
who comes to Him in faith.

*The Patriarch Joseph the All-Comely, Tone 8*

Jacob lamented the loss of  
Joseph, but the brave one was  
seated in a chariot and honored  
as a king; for when he refused to  
be enslaved by the pleasures of

the Egyptian woman, he was  
glorified by Him, who beholds  
the hearts of men and bestows  
an incorruptible crown.

## LAMENT THAT THE INFLUENCE OF GRACE HAS BEEN IGNORED

Like the publican I sigh, like the harlot I shed tears, like the thief I call out, like the prodigal son I entreat Thee. O Christ my Savior and Lover of mankind, strengthen my soul which has grown faint, which has been paralyzed with the intoxication of delights; heal its scabs and wash it, blackened with sin, with Thine honorable blood!

According to the multitude of Thy loving-kindness, convert me, O only Longsuffering One, and deliver me from all sensual indulgence. Extinguish the furnace of my passions, so that they will not burn me up in the end.

Woe is me! Thou, O Lord, hast given me the light of knowledge, and I have clouded it. Woe is me! Constantly hast Thou visited Thy grace upon me and yet dost Thou visit it upon me, but hourly have I rejected this gift for my healing and yet do I reject it.

What a great multitude of gifts hast Thou bestowed upon me and yet dost

Thou bestow them upon me, a sinner, O Master; but I who am wretched have always been and continue to be consciously ungrateful before Thee!

Thy grace comforts me, enlightens me and strengthens me, but I in my negligence turn my attention to vain things and I always sink once again into the bile and bitterness of my passions.

Thou, O All-good One, remindest me of death and of eternal torments and drawest me toward life in order to save me, but I ever shun these saving thoughts. I drive them out and occupy myself with that which is of no benefit to me. Thus have I no justification before Thee.

I knock at the door of Thy loving-kindness, O Lord, that it may be opened to me. I do not cease to pray that I may receive what I request, and unwavering I seek pardon.

Be ever patient with me, depraved as I am; deliver me from the sins which possess me that, having become whole, I may arise from the death-bed of corrupting sin.

Free me from my wanton habits before the end overtakes me, for who will confess Thee in hell?

Make white my garment before the terrible command catches me unprepared and ashamed.

Deliver my contrite soul from the mouths of the lions and save it according to Thy grace and mercy, by the prayers of our All-pure Lady the Theotokos and of all the saints. *St Ephrem the Syrian, Psalm 9*

## Exhortations from Holy Scriptures to Purity

*Romans 8:6-8*

For to be carnally minded is death; but to be spiritually minded is life and peace. Because the carnal mind is enmity against God; for it is not subject

to the law of God, neither indeed can it be. So, they that are in the flesh cannot please God.

*1 Corinthians 6:13-20*

Now the body is not for fornication, but for the Lord; and the Lord for the body. Know ye not that your bodies are the members of Christ? Shall I then take the members of Christ, and make them the members of a harlot? God forbid. What! Know ye not that he which is joined to a harlot is one body? For two, saith he, shall be one flesh. But he that is joined unto the Lord is one spirit. Flee

fornication. Every sin that a man doeth is without the body; but he that committeth fornication sinneth against his own body. What! Know ye not that the body is the temple of the Holy Spirit which is in you, which ye have of God, and ye are not your own? For ye are bought with a price: therefore, glorify God in your body, and in your spirit, which are God's.

*Galatians 5:19-21*

Now the works of the flesh are manifest, which are these: adultery, fornication, uncleanness, lasciviousness, idolatry, witchcraft, hatred, variance, emulations, wrath, strife, seditions, heresies, envyings,

murders, drunkenness, revelings, and such like, of the which I tell you before, as I have also told in the time past, that they which do such things shall not inherit the Kingdom of God.

*Ephesians 5:3-6*

But fornication, and all uncleanness, or covetousness, let it not be once named among you, as becometh saints; neither filthiness, nor foolish talking, nor jesting, which are not convenient, but rather giving of thanks. For this ye know, that no whoremonger, nor

unclean person, nor covetous man, who is an idolater, have an inheritance of Christ and of God. Let no man deceive you with vain words, for because of these things cometh the wrath of God upon the children of disobedience.

*1 Thessalonians 4:3-5*

For this is the will of God, even your sanctification, that ye should abstain from fornication: that every one of you should know how to possess his vessel

in sanctification and honor; not in the lust of concupiscence... For God hath not called us unto uncleanness, but unto holiness.

*Jude 7*

Even as Sodom and Gomorrah, and the cities about them in like manner, giving themselves over to fornication,

and going after strange flesh, are set forth for an example, suffering the vengeance of eternal fire.

**GLORY BE TO GOD FOR ALL THINGS. AMEN.**

<http://www.euphrosynoscafe.com/forum/viewtopic.php?t=5086>